

HS 306: Introduction to German Literature

Course Code	HS 306
Course Name	Introduction to German Literature
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	Outside Discipline/ Free Elective for MA, UG (3rd and 4th year)
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	52nd BoA (Nov 2023)

Course Contents

- **Fairy Tales/ Folktales:** In this module select fairy tales/ folktales (by Grimm Brothers) will be discussed in order to introduce students to reading literary texts in German language. The selected texts will further be analyzed from a literary and linguistic perspective, enabling students to engage critically with these universal texts. Literary tools, methods of interpretation and basic German grammar will also be an intrinsic part of this module. (12 Lectures)
- **Fables:** Similar to the first module, this module shall discuss fables and provide students with a different genre to explore. One can also discuss characteristics of every genre in question and allow students to get an insight into studying different types of literary texts. (8 Lectures)
- **Short Stories, Anecdotes, and Parables:** This module shall be dedicated to yet another type of prose, short stories, anecdotes and parables in order to enable students to engage with as many types of texts as possible. Select anecdotes, parables and prominent short stories, particularly from the Truemmer-literature (Post War Germany 1945-1947) will also be a part of this module. Some well-known authors of this time include Wolfgang Borchert and Heinrich Boell. (12 Lectures)
- **Poetry:** This module shall deal primarily with different forms of poetry, including ballads, poems. Select popular German authors and their poetry shall be the object of analysis in this module. Students will be provided with basic literary and linguistic tools to analyze the deep layers of poetry and encouraged to produce individual interpretations. (10 Lectures)

Text Books

1. Daniel Chandler, **An Introduction to Genre Theory**, 1997
2. Thomas Beebe, **German Literature as World Literature**, Bloomsbury 2014

References

1. Aesops Fables: The Wolf and the Lamb (Der Wolf und der Lamm)
2. Aesops Fables: The Fox and the Crow (Vom Fuchs und Raben)
3. Charles Perrault: Bluebeard (Blaubart)
4. Christa Reinig: Scorpion (Skorpion)
5. Grimm Brothers: Cinderella (Aschenputtel)
6. Grimm Brothers: Hansel und Gretel (Haensel und Gretel)
7. Grimm Brothers: Little Red Riding Hood (Rotkaepchen)
8. Grimm Brothers: The Fisherman and his Wife (Vom Fischer und seiner Frau)
9. Heinrich Boell: Anecdote concerning the Lowering of Productivity (Anekdote zur Senkung der Arbeitsmoral)
10. Johann Wolfgang von Goethe: Elf King (Erlkoenig)
11. Joseph von Eichendorff: Moon Night (Mondnacht), Longing (Sehnsucht)
12. Rainer Maria-Rilke: The Panther (Der Panther)
13. Wolfgang Borchert: The Kitchen Clock (Die Kuechenuhr)
14. Wolfdietrich Schnurre: On The Run (Auf der Flucht)